F04 — Bank Pricing & Value Validation Field Guide

Non-binding discovery, calculation and commercial readiness templates | Version 1.0 | 19 October 2026

NOT AUTHORISED FOR EXTERNAL USE. Obtain PSS Legal/CISO/CEO approval before approaching banks, handling protected records, proposing price terms or making representations about PSS systems.

1. Interview sequence — neutral, no leading claims

- Invite the bank to describe its last three difficult merchant reconciliation, reversal or missing-status cases before discussing proposed PSS capabilities.
- Quantify cases/month, staff-hours, cost per case, age of unresolved cases, financial remediation costs and customer-service burden. Ask for data owner and evidence source.
- Explore in-house remedy, incumbent provider, national infrastructure services and no-change alternatives. Ask what each alternative costs today.
- Identify service decision maker, economic buyer, CFO budget holder, architecture/security reviewer and procurement route.
- Test separate bundles and charging principles without anchoring to fictitious PSS tariffs. Invite the bank to suggest acceptable ranges or absolute budget ceilings.
- Ask what evidence, service levels, implementation burden, exit clauses and internal approvals would be needed to fund a limited pilot.
- Summarise back the bank's own baseline and ask for written corrections; record non-interest and disconfirming facts explicitly.

2. Structured price-response record

Data field	Bank response	Validation rule
Bank ID / date	[blank]	No identifiable banking data in unsanctioned storage
Economic buyer / budget owner	[blank]	Authority checked from role and procurement path
Problem and baseline	[blank]	Measured or source-backed cases / costs
Current alternative cost	[blank]	Finance or procurement evidence
Subscription / service tier reaction	[blank]	No prefilled ETB tariff; neutral elicitation
Merchant service unit price	[blank]	Per actively serviced merchant only
Implementation fee and term	[blank]	Written conditions / upfront effort
Non-overlapping monthly bank benefit	[blank]	CFO-reviewed savings calculation
Adoption / budget / constraints	[blank]	No commitment until valid buyer approval
Evidence level	[blank]	L0–L5 per V03 ladder; L5 only enforceable signed terms

3. Offer comparison / neutral concept prompts

Option	Neutral evaluation question
In-house operations upgrade	Could current teams/process automation solve this at lower lifecycle cost?
PSS Operate + Connect	Which operation would you pay to outsource or automate, and why?
PSS Pay-led alternative	Is acceptance-channel expansion a greater priority than reconciliation?
Specialist / partner managed	Would a third party achieve the same benefit with less fixed spend?
Do nothing	What is the actual cost of the status quo versus change risk?

4. How to interpret interview evidence

L0 = no response; L1 = stated problem; L2 = quantified problem or value; L3 = identified economic buyer and budget pathway; L4 = authorised, non-binding written scope/pricing interest; L5 = binding contract. No statement of enthusiasm, letter of introduction or proposed meeting counts as a commercial commitment.

5. Post-joining tasks and sign-off

Action	Owner	Prerequisite
Issue controlled official interview invitation	RPB&D / CEO	Institutional representation authority
Confirm permitted bank data-handling	Legal / CISO	Consent, confidentiality, data minimisation
Verify price components / taxes	PSS CFO	Cost model, VAT/FX, contracts
Document quantitative bank baseline	Bank Operations/Finance	Evidence-sharing agreement
Confirm exit and liability boundaries	PSS Legal + bank	Detailed service term sheet
Independent review and revise price case	Risk/Internal Audit	Evidence complete and reconciled

6. Researcher declaration

No interviews, price tests, contracts or monetary offers were completed during production of this guide. Observations and legal/cost determinations will require authenticated internal or consenting partner evidence and formal review.